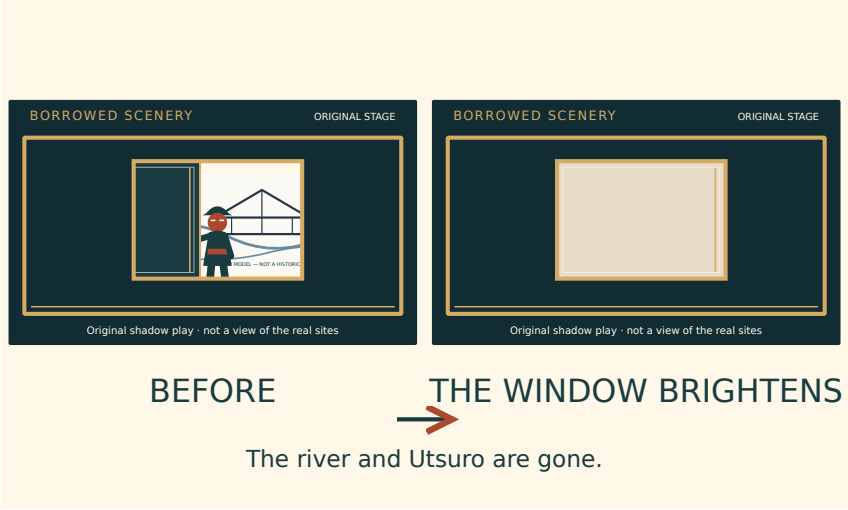
The River Thief

A five-stop Tokyo mystery · One river. Two names. One escape you will see through.



The river fills the little stage. A dark screen sweeps across the window. When the window clears, the river is gone. Only a caption remains: CHITOSE-ZA SCENE / INASE RIVER.

That final scene was meant to be yours to keep. Now a thief calling himself Utsuro has withheld the ending of this travelling picture show. He does not flee Tokyo. He steps into the part you cannot see.

At five real places, reconstruct the views and find his exit. Make him try the same trick again—with both the river and its thief in view.

OPENING CAPTION · A condition within the fictional show

CHITOSE-ZA SCENE / INASE RIVER. Clearing instruction: anything added later stays outside the frame.

Utsuro's annotation (a character's claim, not a historical fact): Keep Hamacho Park as old scenery; remove later additions such as play equipment.

The characters and caper belong to a contemporary fictional picture show. The screen is not a live feed, and illustrations are not site photographs. Your real-world task is observation and puzzling, not following strangers or finding a real suspect.

Print only one language per team. Preparation and cutting: p. 2.
Tasks & original pieces p. 4—p. 17 · Sources p. 18—p. 20
Hints & checking p. 21—p. 26 · All six ending scenes p. 27—p. 29

Carry the same river

01 Button Museum exterior | 02 Ryogoku Bridge | 03 Free Basho garden | 04 Hamacho Park | 05 Meijiza exterior

1. Carry the same scene through five stops: Button Museum exterior → Ryogoku Bridge → free Basho garden → Hamacho Park → Meijiza exterior. Every chapter and the finale are available from the start.
2. Look at the site, then manipulate your own cards. The free history cards are evidence, not a test of Japanese knowledge. Diagrams are not to scale and are not navigation maps.
3. Each stop has three free hints. Assistance is recorded, with the complete ending and souvenir preserved. Correct early solutions count; no collection of chapter stamps is required.
4. Midway, verify independently or exchange calibration. At the end, sign independently or jointly. These are separate choices; all four combinations receive the full ending.
5. For desktop play use the diagrams and sources, without marking a site visit. On site, use those same backup materials if a view is blocked and record that fact. Never trespass to finish.

Prepare before you leave

For a team of 2–4, print one language only. Bring a pen, clipboard and clips. Print A4, single-sided at 100%, without fit-to-page. No duplex registration is needed. Cut movable pieces and fold the souvenir before leaving.

Three view cards, three horizontal river strips and frame; two-face river card and two labels; two timelines and lower-bound strip; park A/B, four camera markers, two purpose labels and facade reference; four theatre-name strips and 1928 move; receipt and foldable two-face souvenir.

Keep task pages and cut pieces readily accessible. Clip source and reveal appendices separately, but carry them with you and use the printed page references.

Playing entirely on paper

Take turns observing, holding diagrams and recording. After each puzzle, check that stop’s appendix, then read its scene change and next stop. Check the seven finale entries and read all six ending frames. A teammate may read hints aloud; neither a host nor a phone is required.

Observe only from permitted public areas. No museum, sports-centre or theatre entry is needed. Do not move objects, approach barriers or treat passers-by as clues. The free Basho garden has opening hours and closed days; follow current notices. Characters, caper and picture show are fictional; venues are not participants. Pause whenever needed. Hints and assistance are free.

Team / date：_____ Mode：□ Desktop □ Field

At each stop record site observation or backup materials and any hints used. Neither reduces the ending or reward.

He has taken your last scene

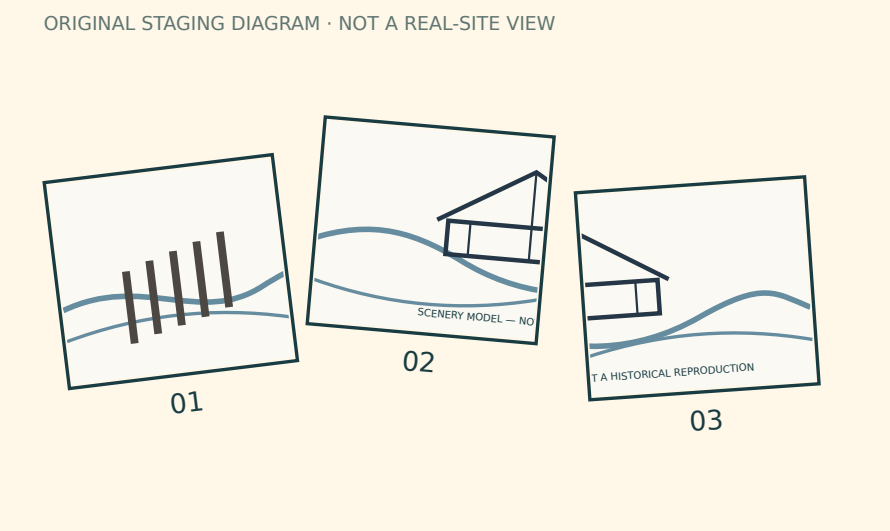
Reading page · do not cut

> **Utsuro** Who gets the last scene? Whoever sees my whole exit. One condition: dress the scene for Chitose-za's time. Anything added later stays out of the frame.
>
> **Shio** He has marked the park sheet too: "Keep Hamacho Park as old scenery. Remove the play equipment." All I have are these loose view studies. Shall I cut to black? …No. You have not had your ending.
>
> **Utsuro** Follow my address, if you like. Kindly ignore my feet.

Place the screen

Take the folded souvenir card with its narrow-window face up. Once S01 is assembled, place it across one end of the original frame to cover part of the strips. Keep the other papers beside it, available whenever needed. Leave the six ending frames unread for now.

Souvenir: p. 17. Start with this street corner, before searching another city for Utsuro.



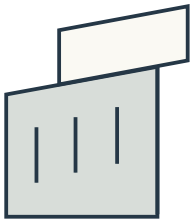
01 · Keep the obscured piece

Public street corner outside the Button Museum building · 1-11-8 Nihonbashi-Hamacho

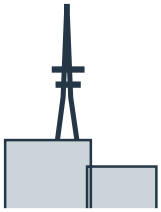
> **Shio** A piece of that advertisement is missing. Would the view look cleaner if I took this card out?
>
> **Utsuro** Clean. Excellent. Much easier to leave.

Do not throw it away yet. Compare the distant tower, traffic sign and building edge within one continuous street view. A sign covering an advertisement does not mean the advertisement is damaged. The museum describes picture buttons painted on separate plates and the back of glass to suggest depth. Your three view cards are original game materials, not antique buttons. Reconnect the view so Shio knows what must stay together.

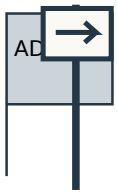
Building / roof edge



Distant tower / nearer block



Traffic sign / advertisement



Continuous-view order: _____ → _____ → _____

Which reading is justified?	☐ Keep the foreground: the layers belong to one view ☐ Invent the missing text and treat each as an address ☐ Move the real sign to reveal the view

Use stable shapes and overlaps. Do not reconstruct hidden lettering, count windows or move the sign.

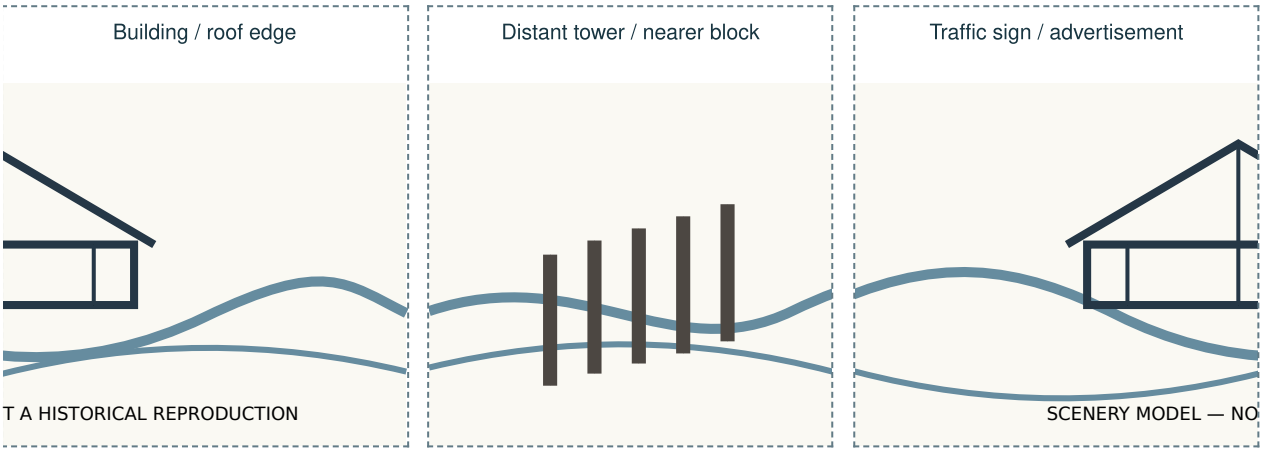
For hints or solution checking, turn to p. 21. Read hints 1 → 2 → 3 as needed. After answering, read the scene change. Everything is free.

01B · Original strips and frame

Materials · print at 100%

Order the three view cards and decide whether the overlap should remain or be “repaired”. On paper, put the matching three river strips into the frame in the same order. They join horizontally; they are not separate depth layers.

Cut each dashed outline · join the three strips horizontally



ORIGINAL FRAME: join the three strips horizontally

CHITOSE-ZA SCENE / INASE RIVER. Clearing instruction: anything added later stays outside the frame.

> **B02 · 纽扣博物馆：收藏品 / Button Museum collection**
>
> The museum describes eighteenth-century English picture buttons painted on plates and the back of glass to suggest depth. This fact comes from the collection text, not a free outdoor display. The game drawings and strips are original.

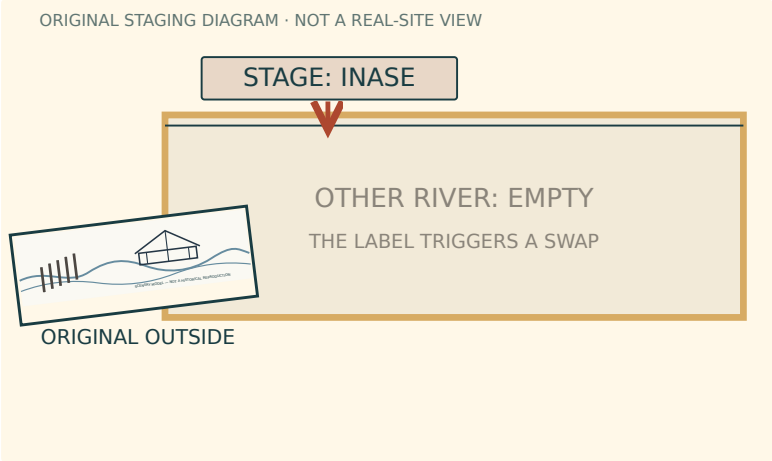
Original diagrams, not museum reproductions. The view cards and horizontal strips are not detachable depth layers. Do not cut out their foreground objects.

02 · Two names for one river

Ryogoku Bridge public pavement and visible river junction · do not spread the kit across the walkway

> **Utsuro** The caption says Inase. Keep watching the Sumida, and I shall leave through the other name.
>
> **Shio** I could replace the caption. But would that misidentify the play as well?

Orient the river diagram using the main river, the Kanda River junction and Yanagi Bridge together. The source card reveals a useful distinction: in Kosode Soga Azami no Ironui, scenery associated with the Sumida's riverside piles is used for a stage setting named Inase River. Both names can be correct. The open-air playhouses of west Ryogoku also begin the theatre history on your closing caption. Keep this river in the show; do not let a valid stage name replace its real source.

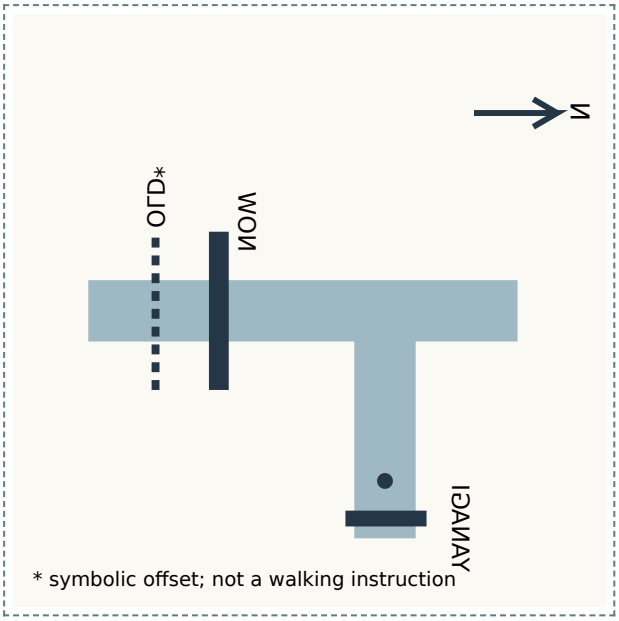


> Rotate or turn over the river card. Place the stage-name and real-scenery labels separately. Keeping both preserves the relationship that makes this borrowed scene work.

> **R02 · 日本艺术文化振兴会：稻瀬川百本杭 / Japan Arts Council**
>
> In Kosode Soga Azami no Ironui, the Inase River stage setting borrows scenery associated with the Sumida's riverside piles. The game uses only this specific scenic relationship, not the play's characters or events, and not a rule for every use of "Inase".

> **M01 · 明治座：喜昇座时代 / Kisho-za**
>
> The official history traces the predecessor to the open-air San Kyodai playhouses of west Ryogoku and the opening of Kisho-za in 1873. This connects the riverside history with the endpoint; it does not put the 1873 theatre at today's bridgehead.

02A · Orient the river; place both labels



Rotate this card. To view the other side, use the alternate river face on the next page; no precise duplex registration is needed. Compare either face with the main river, tributary and bridges.

Stage name	☐ Inase River ☐ Sumida River
Real scenery	☐ Sumida River ☐ Inase River

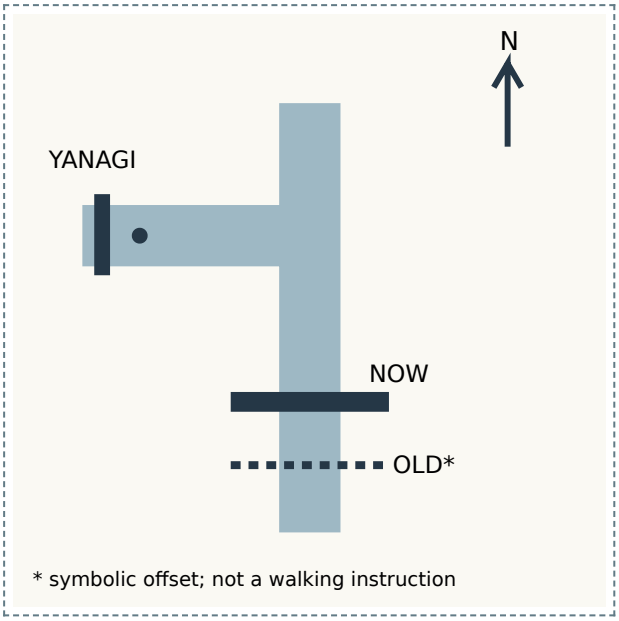
Align all three geographical relationships. The old-bridge line is schematic, not an exact overlay on today's bridge.

Legend: N north; YANAGI Yanagi Bridge; NOW present Ryogoku Bridge; OLD symbolic old bridge.

For hints or solution checking, turn to p. 22. Read hints 1 → 2 → 3 as needed. After answering, read the scene change. Everything is free.

02B · Alternate face and two labels

Materials · the other face of the same river



稲瀬川 / INASE

隅田川 / SUMIDA

STAGE NAME: _____

REAL SCENERY: _____

R01 · 墨田区观光协会：旧两国桥 / Old Ryogoku Bridge

The old bridge was about 50 metres downstream of the present one; the riverbank has a history of sideshows and stalls. The game does not precisely overlay old and new bridge positions or count modern railings as historical piles.

On the bridge, hold only the page you need. Spread the kit only at a permitted stopping place clear of pedestrian traffic.

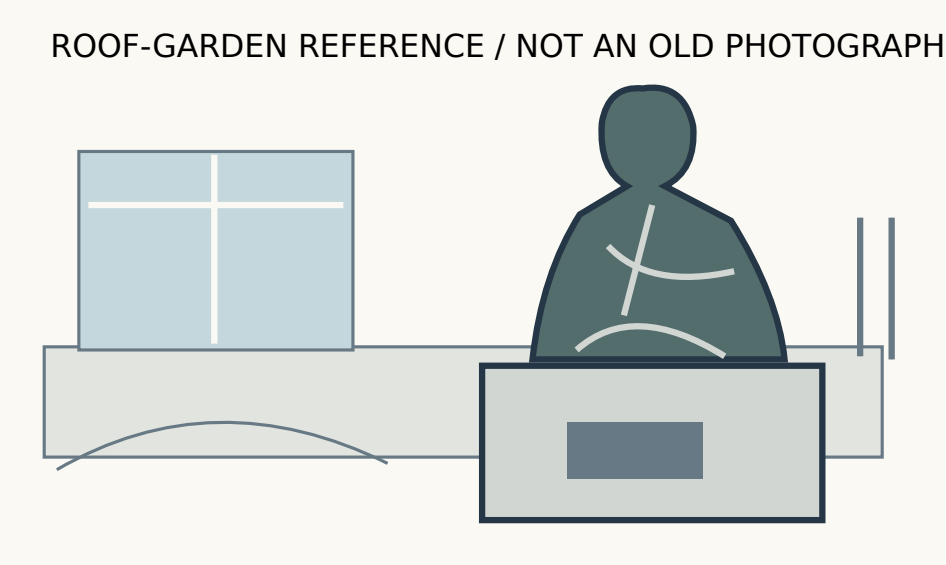
03 · An old poet, a newer view

Basho-an historic observation garden · free roof garden at the annex, 1-1-3 Tokiwa

Utsuro An old poet deserves an old view. “1930” ought to carry enough weight.

Shio Let us not vouch for the label yet. We can check the poet and the garden separately.

Compare the seated figure, plinth and scenery wall with the supplied reference. Two sourced records matter: Basho moved to Fukagawa in 1680; this free observation garden opened in April 1995. The kit contains a functional drawing of a modern reference, not a museum photograph for authentication. Can Utsuro call that reference an original photograph from 1930? Establish its earliest possible date without inventing an exact shooting date.



H07 · 江东区：芭蕉与深川 / Basho in Fukagawa

Basho moved from Nihonbashi to Fukagawa in 1680. This belongs to his life, not to the creation date of the present garden, statue or reference view.

H01 · 芭蕉纪念馆：馆概要 / Basho Museum outline

The main museum opened in 1981, the annex in January 1995 and its roof observation garden in April 1995. The garden is free, has published hours of 09:15–16:30 and covers 101.88 square metres. A reference showing this setting can establish only a lower bound of 1995 or later.

“No earlier than” does not mean “exactly that year”, or “live today”.

03B · Two timelines

Materials and answers · distinguish person from setting

> Use separate timelines for the person and the memorial setting, then choose precisely what the date can establish.

PERSON: Basho moves to Fukagawa _____

SETTING: this garden can be photographed _____

LOWER BOUND: no earlier than _____; the exact year remains unknown.

Basho moved to Fukagawa	☐ 1680 ☐ 1930 ☐ 1995
Lower bound for a photograph of this setting	☐ 1930 ☐ 1981 ☐ 1995
What does this lower bound establish?	☐ 1995 or later; not the exact year ☐ Exactly 1995 ☐ It commemorates an old person, so 1930 must be valid

After checking this stop, choose how to continue

□ Verify the diagram independently

□ Exchange calibration

This affects initial park-map calibration only. You still choose the camera side and purpose. If you have already started the park puzzle, changing this choice does not reset that work.

For hints or solution checking, turn to p. 23. Read hints 1 → 2 → 3 as needed. After answering, read the scene change. Everything is free.

04 · Keep the foreground

Hamacho Park map and permitted public path on the playground side

> **Utsuro** Our original instruction: Hamacho Park in Chitose-za's time. Remove the play equipment. Keep that stage-like building. No foreground. Delightfully clear.
>
> **Shio** Wait. He is not asking for a clearer view. He is choosing what must not appear.

Utsuro pushes the opening's clearing instruction towards you. Your source cards give three dates: Chitose-za, 1885; Meiji-za, 1893; the reconstruction park, 1929. Place them beside "Hamacho Park in Chitose-za's time". Does removing modern play equipment really recover the old scene he claims?

Then examine today's view study. Orient the park map so the river edge, large field and sports centre all agree. The reference shows play equipment before a diamond-patterned facade. Which side keeps both in view?

Utsuro's annotation (a character's claim, not a historical fact): Keep Hamacho Park as old scenery; remove later additions such as play equipment.

M03 · 明治座：千歳座时代 / Chitose-za

The Chitose-za name began on 4 January 1885. The year strips are accessible from the start and may be read at S04 alongside the 1893 name change and the park's 1929 opening.

M04 · 明治座诞生 / The Meiji-za name

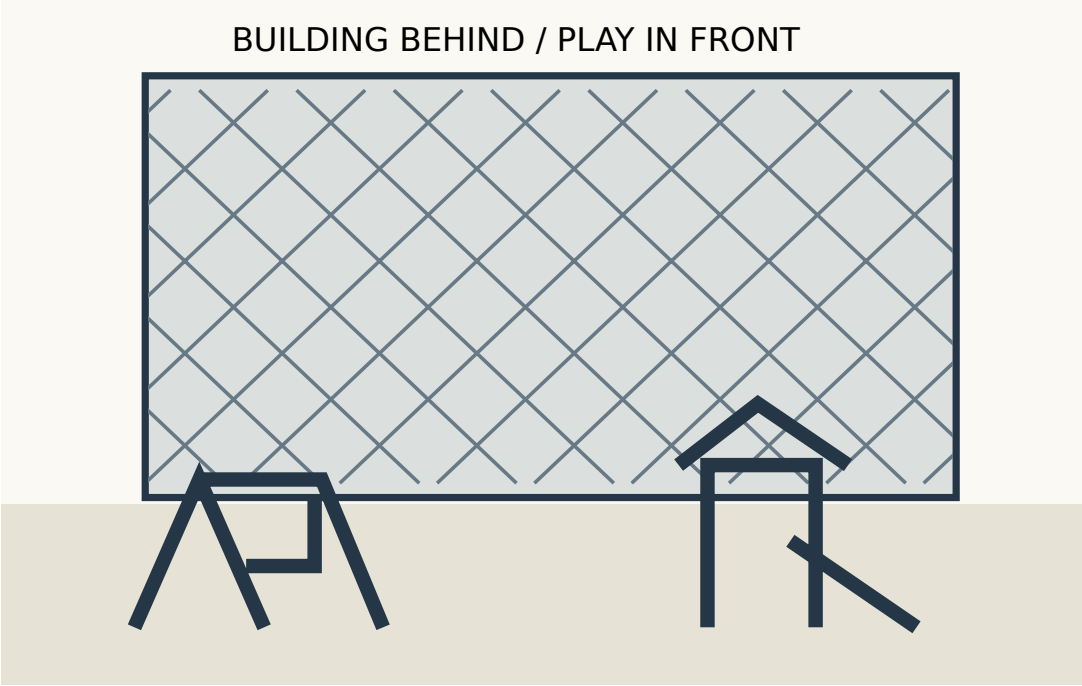
The theatre opened under the Meiji-za name in 1893. Kisho → Hisamatsu → Chitose → Meiji is the historical sequence, not a continuous camera view across locations.

P01 · 东京都立图书馆：浜町公园 / Tokyo Metropolitan Library

Hamacho Park opened in 1929 as one of three major parks planned in the imperial-capital reconstruction programme. Removing modern play equipment from today's view is therefore not an evidenced reconstruction of a "Chitose-za-era park". The year does not date any present building or establish old plot boundaries.

Compare the clearing instruction with the dates, then orient the modern map independently. Choose the camera side, depicted building and purpose of the sheet. Dates test the old-scene claim; the present layout tells you which way to look.

04A · Keep foreground and background



Original functional reference: play equipment in front, diamond facade behind. This is not a photograph and does not date the building.

Which camera side gives the reference view?	☐ Playground side ☐ River side ☐ Circular-entrance side ☐ Large-field side
Building in the reference	☐ Sports centre ☐ Meijiza
Purpose of this page	☐ CAPTURE AT: view location ☐ DELIVER TO: recipient address

CAPTURE AT identifies a viewing position, not a building to deliver something into. Observe from an open public path, without entering play areas or buildings.

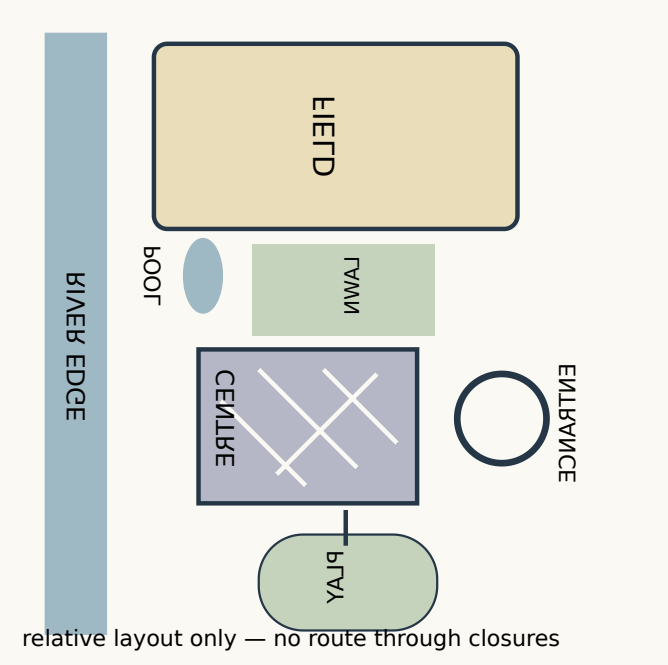
For hints or solution checking, turn to p. 24. Read hints 1 → 2 → 3 as needed. After answering, read the scene change. Everything is free.

04B · Park card and viewpoint

Materials · do not follow diagram lines into restricted areas

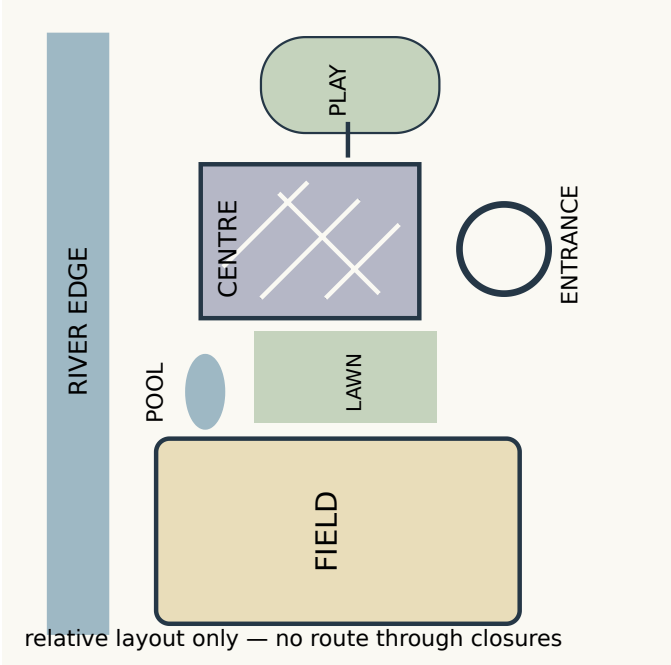
Cut A and B, then clip them back-to-back to simulate turning the map over; you may also rotate them separately. No transparency or exact registration is needed. Match river edge, large field and sports centre together.

FACE A



relative layout only — no route through closures

FACE B



relative layout only — no route through closures

Camera markers · choose one

☐ PLAYGROUND SIDE	☐ RIVER SIDE
☐ CIRCULAR ENTRANCE	☐ FIELD SIDE
CAPTURE AT VIEW FROM HERE	DELIVER TO DELIVER HERE

Read only if you chose “Exchange calibration”

Turn Face B a quarter-turn clockwise: river edge above, field left, sports centre right. This aligns the large anchors only. You still place the camera and choose the purpose.

Legend: FIELD, CENTRE (sports centre), PLAY (playground), ENTRANCE, POOL, LAWN. The layout does not establish access on the day.

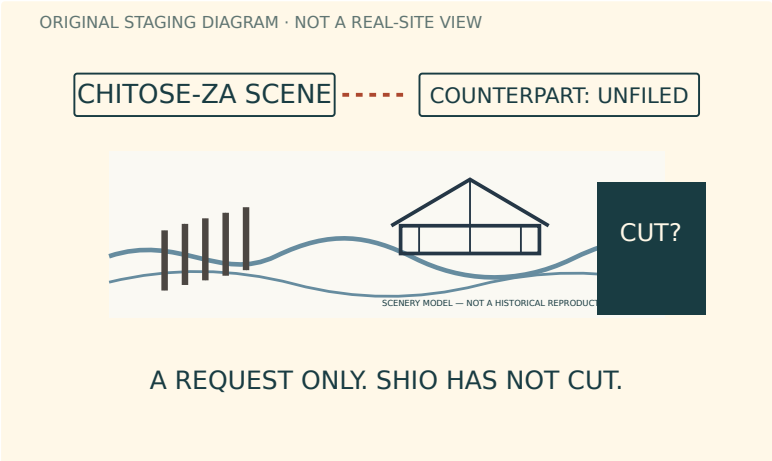
05 · Bring the caption into the present

Public pavement outside Meijiza · check the exterior sign, then move clear of the entrance

> **Utsuro** Chitose-za is gone. Would not an empty frame make the most elegant ending?
>
> **Shio** An empty frame tells us nothing of where this came from. The west-Ryogoku playhouses are still here in these history strips.

Join the four names into one history, then put 1928 on a separate track. Meijiza's official history traces its predecessor to the open-air playhouses of west Ryogoku. Kisho, Hisamatsu, Chitose and Meiji are not four unrelated addressees. Relocation is not a fifth name.

Check the present exterior sign. Let the opening's "Chitose-za scene" retain its old caption while gaining a present counterpart. You are completing your own closing scene, not delivering property to the theatre.



> **M01 · 明治座：喜昇座时代 / Kisho-za**
>
> The official history traces the predecessor to the open-air San Kyodai playhouses of west Ryogoku and the opening of Kisho-za in 1873. This connects the riverside history with the endpoint; it does not put the 1873 theatre at today's bridgehead.

> **M07 · 昭和的明治座 / Relocation**
>
> After the earthquake the theatre moved near present-day Hamacho Park and reopened on 4 March 1928. This is relocation/reopening, not a fifth name, and does not show that the park viewpoint also frames the theatre.

This is a brief exterior check. The climax takes place in your own picture-show frame. Do not buy a ticket or ask theatre staff to sign.

05B · Names and location on separate tracks

> Order the four name strips. Place 1928 under location history. Keep the old name and present counterpart together, while recording changes of building and location separately.

Chitose-za · 1885

Meiji-za · 1893

Kisho-za · 1873

Hisamatsu-za · 1879

1928 · RELOCATION & REOPENING

NAME HISTORY: _____ → _____ → _____ → _____

LOCATION HISTORY: _____

Where does 1928 belong?	☐ Relocation/reopening within the identity history ☐ A fifth theatre name

For hints or solution checking, turn to p. 25. Read hints 1 → 2 → 3 as needed. After answering, read the scene change. Everything is free.

Finale · This time, no blackout

Shio has her hand on the frame. Bring the materials you kept into one account: real river, stage name, kind of project, earliest possible reference date, viewpoint and the old name's present counterpart. The ending belongs to your own picture show; the game host receives the receipt.

Give Shio the complete composition to hold. Invite Utsuro to try the opening's screen again. This time, watch the part he did not want you to see.

Real scenery	☐ 隅田川 / Sumida ☐ 稲瀬川 / Inase
Stage name	☐ 稲瀬川 / Inase ☐ 隅田川 / Sumida
Nature of this show's project	☐ Contemporary project borrowing historical scenery ☐ Original photograph from 1930
Lower bound of the referenced modern view	☐ 1995 or later, not an exact date ☐ Exactly 1995
Viewpoint or delivery destination?	☐ A camera position by the playground facing the sports centre ☐ Deliver the closing scene to the sports centre
Present counterpart of the old name	☐ 明治座 / Meijiza ☐ 千歳座 / Chitose only ☐ 芭蕉纪念馆 / Basho Museum
Where does this game receipt go?	☐ Submit the original scene and receipt to the game host ☐ Use the prop for admission or ask theatre staff to sign

□ Independent signature · our team receives the scene

□ Joint signature · receive the scene with Shio

When ready, check p. 26 and read all six ending frames. No five-stamp requirement: a correct early solution counts.

Receipt and foldable souvenir

Materials · both faces come from one printed side

ORIGINAL SCENE RECEIPT

Stage name / real scenery: _____

Lower bound of the modern reference: _____

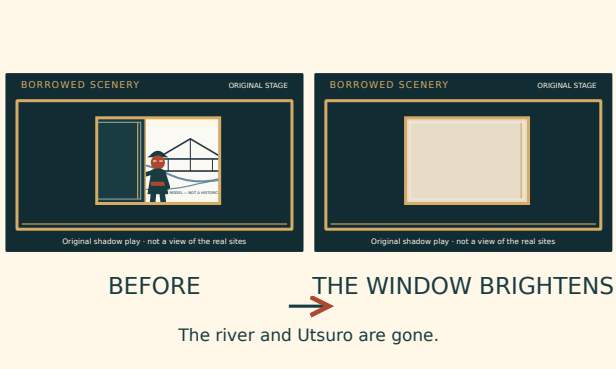
Viewpoint / purpose: _____

Old name → present counterpart: _____

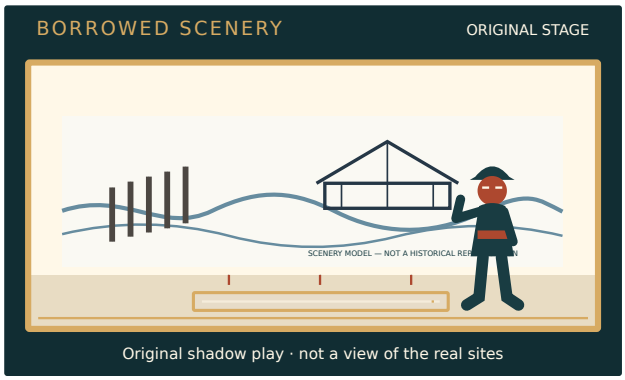
Team signature / Shio (if joint): _____

One souvenir, two faces

FRONT · NARROW WINDOW / SCREEN



BACK · WHOLE STAGE / SCREEN DOWN



Cut the outer border only. Fold the centre dashed line with the illustrations facing out, blank backs together. Folded size approximately 86 × 67 mm.

Keep the three horizontal river strips assembled in the S01 frame. At the opening place the souvenir card's narrow-window face across one end, partly covering the strips. Read the six-scene ending in order. At scene six, turn the same card to its complete-stage face and place it beside the frame, revealing the same entire scene. Then sign. This is a paper storyboard, not an optical device or an extra puzzle.

This original souvenir is not a ticket, museum object or venue authorization. It covers one end of the original scene; it neither replaces nor separates the three strips.

History to carry · 1

Separate historical sources from claims made by fictional characters. URLs allow verification; the needed facts are printed here, so internet access is optional. Research date: 20 October 2026.

B02 · 纽扣博物馆：收藏品 / Button Museum collection

The museum describes eighteenth-century English picture buttons painted on plates and the back of glass to suggest depth. This fact comes from the collection text, not a free outdoor display. The game drawings and strips are original.

https://button-museum.jp/item/

F01 · 既有街角实拍研究 / Existing corner-evidence review

Uses the continuous-view and overlap observations in evidence/02_SITE_BY_SITE_CROSSCHECK.md. Private JPEG/MP4 pixels were not reobtained or re-examined this session. No originals are published; hidden lettering is not reconstructed from OCR.

Existing field-evidence review; original photographs are not included.

R02 · 日本艺术文化振兴会：稻瀬川百本杭 / Japan Arts Council

In Kosode Soga Azami no Ironui, the Inase River stage setting borrows scenery associated with the Sumida's riverside piles. The game uses only this specific scenic relationship, not the play's characters or events, and not a rule for every use of "Inase".

https://www2.ntj.jac.go.jp/dglib/contents/learn/edc17/sakuhin/d2/b.html

R01 · 墨田区观光协会：旧两国桥 / Old Ryogoku Bridge

The old bridge was about 50 metres downstream of the present one; the riverbank has a history of sideshows and stalls. The game does not precisely overlay old and new bridge positions or count modern railings as historical piles.

https://visit-sumida.jp/spot/6182/

H07 · 江东区：芭蕉与深川 / Basho in Fukagawa

Basho moved from Nihonbashi to Fukagawa in 1680. This belongs to his life, not to the creation date of the present garden, statue or reference view.

https://www.city.koto.lg.jp/promotion/kotocity/bashou.html

H01 · 芭蕉纪念馆：馆概要 / Basho Museum outline

The main museum opened in 1981, the annex in January 1995 and its roof observation garden in April 1995. The garden is free, has published hours of 09:15–16:30 and covers 101.88 square metres. A reference showing this setting can establish only a lower bound of 1995 or later.

https://www.kcf.or.jp/basho/outline/

History to carry · 2

Separate historical sources from claims made by fictional characters. URLs allow verification; the needed facts are printed here, so internet access is optional. Research date: 20 October 2026.

H02 · 江东区：芭蕉记念馆 / Koto City garden access

The free garden is at 1-1-3 Tokiwa, distinct from the main museum at 1-6-3. Official information lists the second and fourth Mondays as closed, or the next day when a holiday falls on the Monday. Temporary notices take priority. The old hut and modern memorial are different.

https://www.city.koto.lg.jp/promotion/spot/basho.html

P01 · 东京都立图书馆：浜町公园 / Tokyo Metropolitan Library

Hamacho Park opened in 1929 as one of three major parks planned in the imperial-capital reconstruction programme. Removing modern play equipment from today's view is therefore not an evidenced reconstruction of a "Chitose-za-era park". The year does not date any present building or establish old plot boundaries.

https://www.library.metro.tokyo.lg.jp/portals/0/tokyo/chapter2/park14.html

P02 · 内阁府：帝都复兴 / Cabinet Office reconstruction history

Reconstruction reshaped blocks, roads, bridges and parks. This puzzle does not use an unavailable precise historical plan or infer underground caches, fountain foundations or 1929 facility coordinates.

https://www.bousai.go.jp/kohou/kouhoubousai/r05/108/special_01.html

P06 · 既有公园实拍研究 / Existing park-evidence review

Uses the repository's existing reviews of IMG_3633(1).jpeg and IMG_3636(1).jpeg: relative river-edge, field and sports-centre layout, with play equipment before the diamond facade. Original pixels were not re-examined this session. Kit images are original functional diagrams, not photographs or navigation maps.

Existing field-evidence review; original photographs are not included.

P04 · 中央区：公园部分休止 / Chuo City partial closure

The current notice read on 20 October 2026, dated 3 September 2026, describes partial closure through fiscal 2030. Earlier repository notes said 2029; this is a documented correction, not an erasure of the old record. A map does not establish today's access. The closure date is not a puzzle answer.

https://www.city.chuo.lg.jp/a0037/machizukuri/kouenryokka/kouen/oshirase/hamachosyuuhen.html

M01 · 明治座：喜昇座时代 / Kisho-za

The official history traces the predecessor to the open-air San Kyodai playhouses of west Ryogoku and the opening of Kisho-za in 1873. This connects the riverside history with the endpoint; it does not put the 1873 theatre at today's bridgehead.

https://www.meijiza.co.jp/anniversary/era1.html

History to carry · 3

Separate historical sources from claims made by fictional characters. URLs allow verification; the needed facts are printed here, so internet access is optional. Research date: 20 October 2026.

M02 · 明治座：久松座时代 / Hisamatsu-za

The theatre opened under the Hisamatsu-za name on 6 August 1879. This is institutional history, not proof of an unchanged building.

https://www.meijiza.co.jp/anniversary/era2.html

M03 · 明治座：千歳座时代 / Chitose-za

The Chitose-za name began on 4 January 1885. The year strips are accessible from the start and may be read at S04 alongside the 1893 name change and the park's 1929 opening.

https://www.meijiza.co.jp/anniversary/era3.html

M04 · 明治座诞生 / The Meiji-za name

The theatre opened under the Meiji-za name in 1893. Kisho → Hisamatsu → Chitose → Meiji is the historical sequence, not a continuous camera view across locations.

https://www.meijiza.co.jp/anniversary/era4.html

M07 · 昭和的明治座 / Relocation

After the earthquake the theatre moved near present-day Hamacho Park and reopened on 4 March 1928. This is relocation/reopening, not a fifth name, and does not show that the park viewpoint also frames the theatre.

https://www.meijiza.co.jp/anniversary/era7.html

M05 · 明治座：初次来场 / Visiting Meijiza

This game uses exterior observation only. It grants no venue partnership, admission rights or staff signature. The theatrical view is an original illustration. Submit the receipt to the game host.

https://www.meijiza.co.jp/firstguide/

Check 01 · Keep the obscured piece

HINTS / SOLUTION / SCENE CHANGE · Read as needed

Free hint 1

The cards belong to one continuous view. Distinguish the distant landmark, the nearer traffic sign and the museum building edge.

Free hint 2

Put the distant-tower card at the start and the building/roof edge at the other end. The traffic-sign card joins them. The gap behind the sign is an overlap.

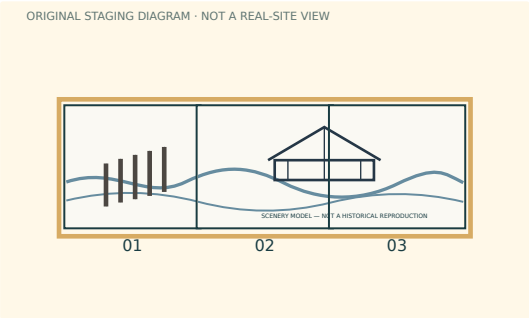
Free hint 3

Tower → sign → building/roof. Keep the foreground overlap. Join the matching river strips in that order without inventing obscured text.

Complete solution

Distant tower / nearer block → Traffic sign / advertisement → Building / roof edge

Which reading is justified?: Keep the foreground: the layers belong to one view



The scene changes

The strips make one river. Shio slides the rejected piece back into the frame, closing the gap from the opening. The river was never three separate addresses: Utsuro showed you only a small part. Keep this same scene for the finale.

> **Shio** It is not broken. Something is in front of it. I should not remove everything in front just because he asks.
>
> **Utsuro** Keep the river, then. Find me at Inase River. Surely a name cannot hide anything?

Continue along public streets to Ryogoku Bridge. Take the same scene and its Inase caption. Is it a real-world location, or the name used on stage?

Check 02 · Two names for one river

HINTS / SOLUTION / SCENE CHANGE · Read as needed

Free hint 1

A vertical main river is not enough: a mirror image can do that too. Check which bank the tributary enters from and which river Yanagi Bridge crosses.

Free hint 2

Restore north to the top and match the main river, tributary and both bridges together. The stage caption does not have to become the real place name.

Free hint 3

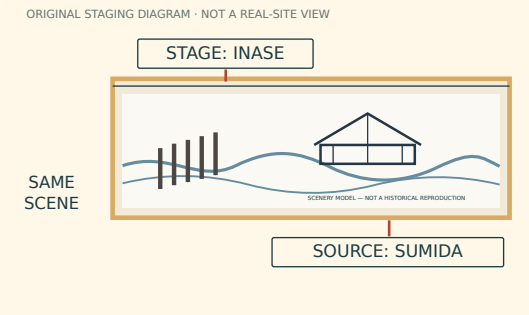
Use the canonical orientation, without mirroring. Stage: Inase. Real scenery: Sumida. On paper, change to the correct face and rotate until all three anchors match.

Complete solution

River card: north arrow up, tributary entering from upper left; use the alternate face in this orientation.

Stage name: Inase River

Real scenery: Sumida River



The scene changes

Shio leaves Inase on the caption and places Sumida in the real-scenery field. The same river returns to the frame. Utsuro keeps his stage name, but it can no longer lead you to a different river. Both names now sit beside one view.

> **Utsuro** Very well. Names will not carry you away. What about time? This reference, you see, is an original photograph from 1930.
>
> **Shio** He means the Basho-garden reference. The poet lived in Fukagawa long ago. But did the garden in this view exist then?

Continue to the Basho-an historic observation garden at 1-1-3 Tokiwa. Separate the lifetime of the person commemorated from the age of the place commemorating him.

Check 03 · An old poet, a newer view

HINTS / SOLUTION / SCENE CHANGE · Read as needed

Free hint 1

An old historical figure does not make a view containing this modern garden equally old. Check the two timelines separately.

Free hint 2

1680 belongs to Basho's move. 1995 belongs to this observation garden. 1981 is the main museum's opening, not this garden's.

Free hint 3

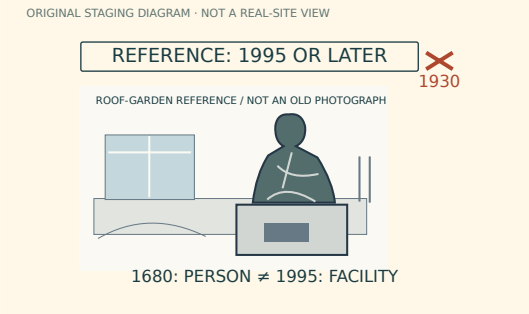
Choose 1680, 1995, and "1995 or later". This rules out the reference being a 1930 original photograph; it does not identify its exact year, maker or a live location.

Complete solution

Basho moved to Fukagawa: 1680

Lower bound for a photograph of this setting: 1995

What does this lower bound establish?: 1995 or later; not the exact year



The scene changes

The "1930 original" label comes down. The reference now says only "1995 or later". Shio keeps the garden without passing it off as the hut Basho knew. Utsuro has lost the authority of an old photograph, but not his argument for clearing the frame: cannot a present-day view still play an earlier time?

> **Utsuro** You have won the argument about the photograph. But I am staging the past. Later things in the park should still go.
>
> **Shio** Then we must check whether the "old scene" he wants to keep is justified. I can share the large-anchor calibration. You will still have to decide where the camera belongs.

Use permitted streets toward Shin-Ohashi and Hamacho Park. Keep the opening annotation. The theatre-year strips are available now, as they have been from the start.

Both midgame responses are printed on p. 30.

Check 04 · Keep the foreground

HINTS / SOLUTION / SCENE CHANGE · Read as needed

Free hint 1

Match river edge, field and sports centre together. Matching only the river may leave a mirror image. The historical date 1929 cannot orient today's map for you.

Free hint 2

In the canonical diagram the river edge is above, the field left and the sports centre right, with the playground beyond it. The foreground tells you which side the observer is on.

Free hint 3

Use the canonical orientation without mirroring. Select playground side, sports centre and CAPTURE AT. Keep the foreground; the sports centre is neither the theatre nor a delivery destination.

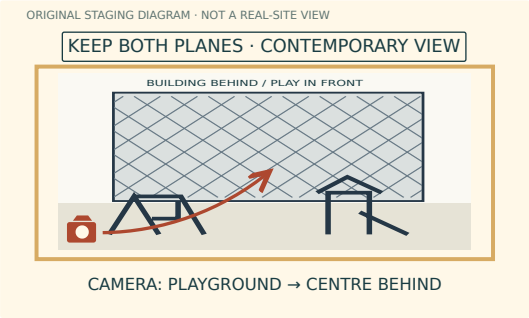
Complete solution

Park card: river edge above, field left, sports centre right. Rotate Face B a quarter-turn clockwise.

Which camera side gives the reference view?: Playground side

Building in the reference: Sports centre

Purpose of this page: CAPTURE AT: view location



The scene changes

A park opened in 1929 cannot be reconstructed as that same park in Chitose-za's 1885–1893 period simply by deleting play equipment. Utsuro's reason for clearing the foreground loses its basis.

You also restore the playground foreground and sports-centre background together. The camera belongs at the observer's end, not inside the building. The near layer crossed by the screen remains visible. Shio holds the frame, knowing which side to keep.

> **Shio** I kept looking at the building, thinking we had to deliver something there. The sheet records where to see it from. This foreground stays. I am done clearing the frame on his say-so.
>
> **Utsuro** You can keep the scene. Can you keep a vanished Chitose-za? The name on your closing reel still has no place in the present.
>
> **Shio** Then we finish its history. We do not make another cut.

Continue to Meijiza's public exterior to identify the old caption's present counterpart. The park viewpoint and theatre exterior are separate places, not one real camera shot.

Check 05 · Bring the caption into the present

HINTS / SOLUTION / SCENE CHANGE · Read as needed

Free hint 1

Separate the four names from the event about location. A move does not create another theatre name.

Free hint 2

Kisho comes before Hisamatsu; Chitose before Meiji. The west-Ryogoku playhouses are the predecessor in this history.

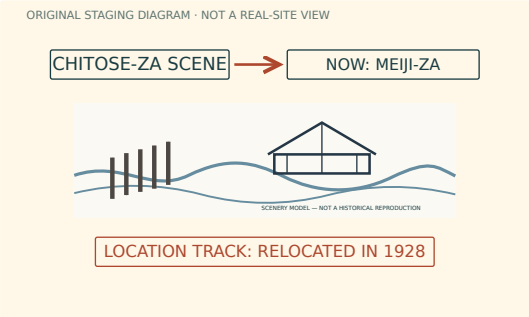
Free hint 3

Kisho-za 1873 → Hisamatsu-za 1879 → Chitose-za 1885 → Meiji-za 1893. Put 1928 under relocation/reopening. The present counterpart is Meijiza; the game host receives your actual receipt.

Complete solution

Kisho-za · 1873 → Hisamatsu-za · 1879 → Chitose-za · 1885 → Meiji-za · 1893

Where does 1928 belong?: Relocation/reopening within the identity history



The scene changes

The opening caption remains intact. It now connects back to west Ryogoku's playhouses and forward to Meijiza's present name, with 1928 recorded separately as a move. The closing scene no longer needs a blank substitute. Shio returns the same strips to the original illustrated stage, keeps the foreground and invites Utsuro to try again.

> **Shio** The same river. The same caption. This time, whoever moves the scenery stays in view.
>
> **Utsuro** Ladies and gentlemen, that last disappearance…allow me another attempt.

Move to a permitted stopping place clear of pedestrian traffic and complete the receipt. Submit whenever your account is complete; an early solution is equally valid.

Keep the river in the same picture

FINALE CHECK · All seven entries agree

Real scenery	隅田川 / Sumida
Stage name	稲瀬川 / Inase
Nature of this show's project	Contemporary project borrowing historical scenery
Lower bound of the referenced modern view	1995 or later, not an exact date
Viewpoint or delivery destination?	A camera position by the playground facing the sports centre
Present counterpart of the old name	明治座 / Meijiza
Where does this game receipt go?	Submit the original scene and receipt to the game host

If an entry differs, revisit its source and operation. You may also use this complete account as assistance and still read the whole ending.

Keep the stage, then read the ending

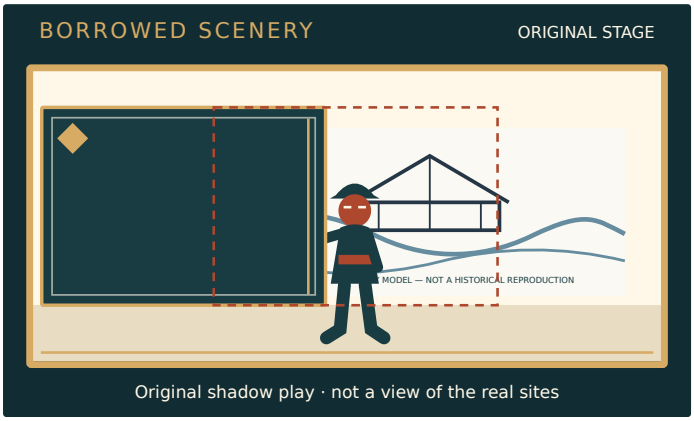
Keep the three horizontal river strips assembled in the S01 frame. At the opening place the souvenir card's narrow-window face across one end, partly covering the strips. Read the six-scene ending in order. At scene six, turn the same card to its complete-stage face and place it beside the frame, revealing the same entire scene. Then sign. This is a paper storyboard, not an optical device or an extra puzzle.

Begin at p. 27. Read all six scenes in order. Independent or joint signatures change only the final response and receipt; neither hides content or reduces the souvenir.

The last scene is yours · 1—2

THE COMPLETE ENDING · Read all six scenes in order

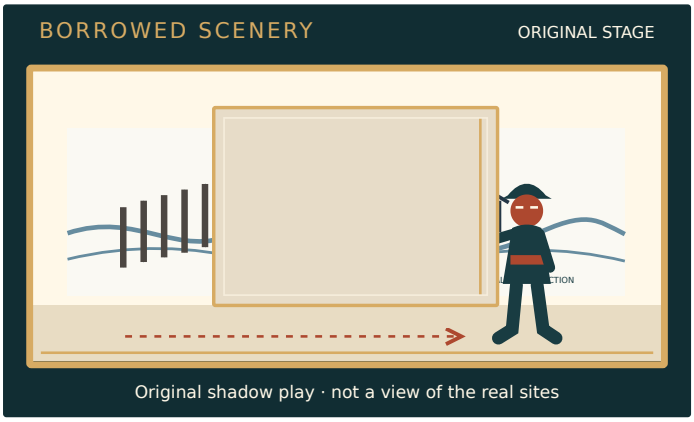
1 · The same river



The original river returns. Its Inase caption remains, as does its Sumida source. Utsuro takes his opening position and raises the same screen.

Utsuro As before. Watch my hands.

2 · Keep the edges



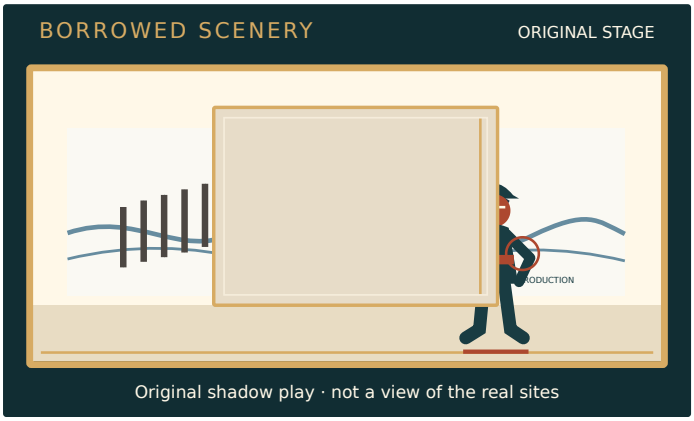
The screen slides sideways. Shio holds the frame in the composition you restored, leaving the blackout untouched. The near layer stays. Utsuro's feet and the screen's edge remain in the wider view.

Shio This time, we keep the edges too.

The last scene is yours · 3—4

THE COMPLETE ENDING · Read all six scenes in order

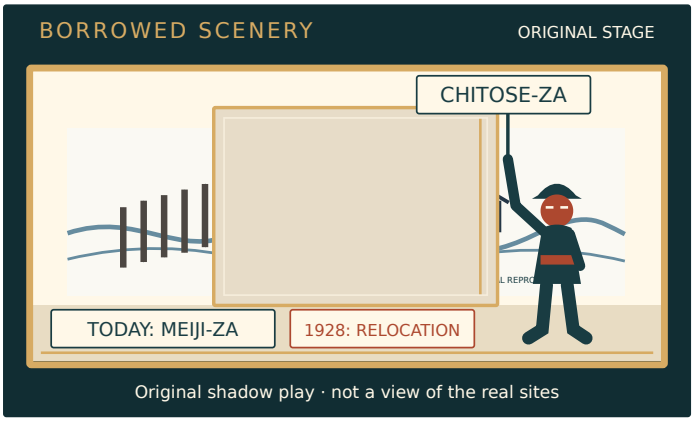
3 · Still in the picture



He steps behind the screen and waits for the familiar blackout. None comes. The river is still there—and so is the person holding the screen. The opening's disappearance was only as large as the narrow window.

> **Utsuro** You have included the part outside the picture?
>
> **Shio** You have not finished your exit.

4 · Keep the caption



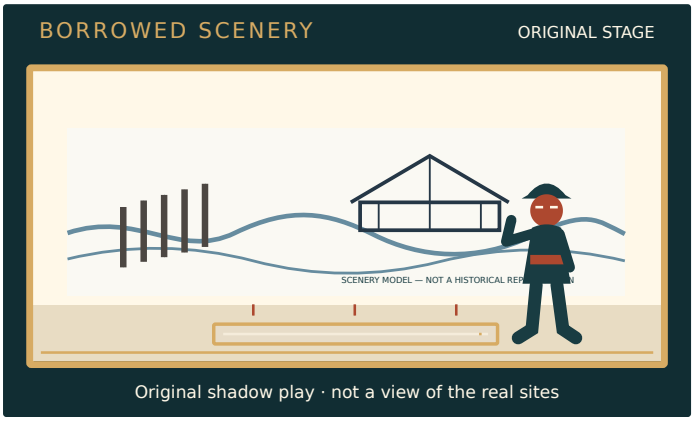
Utsuro raises "Chitose-za" as a cue to cut. Shio places the old caption beside its present counterpart, keeping the 1928 move on another line. No name is erased; no name closes the picture for him.

> **Shio** The caption may be old. We still get to see the end.

The last scene is yours · 5—6

THE COMPLETE ENDING · Read all six scenes in order

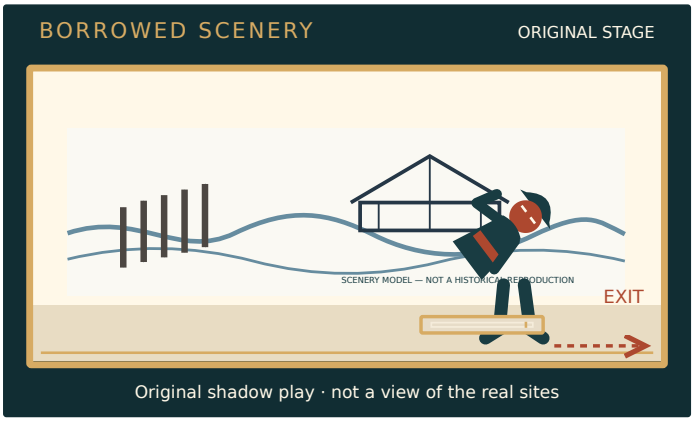
5 · One more person



Utsuro puts the screen down. The withheld ending is finally visible: the same three strips you brought from the street corner. He looks at his hands, now plainly in view.

> **Utsuro** Now you can see the person moving the scenery. Does it still count as a wonder?
>
> **Shio** The river is all here. And now there is one more person.

6 · A complete exit



For the first time he bows without hiding behind the screen. Hat, hands and the final step offstage are visible. The river stays in the frame. The last scene is yours. On paper, turn over the same souvenir card and place it beside the frame, revealing all three original strips.

> **Utsuro** Then lend me a round of applause. I am giving the last scene back.

Independent signature · our team receives the scene

Shio leaves the signature space for your team and holds the other side of the frame. “This time, I follow your view.”

Joint signature · receive the scene with Shio

Shio signs beside your team and releases the frame only when she has finished. “This time, none of us was cropped out.”

Sign beside the scene that stayed

CHOICE APPENDIX · Four combinations, one complete ending

Verify the diagram independently

Shio puts the calibration aside. “All right. I will not orient it for you. Tell me which side to keep in view.” The park card begins in its original, uncalibrated state.

Exchange calibration

Shio shares the large-anchor orientation. “River edge, field, building. Those are aligned. I will not choose the camera side for you.” The park card is initially calibrated; its viewpoint and purpose remain yours to determine.

Midgame	Signature	What you receive
Verify the diagram independently	Independent signature · our team receives the scene	The same truth, all six scenes, original view and souvenir
Verify the diagram independently	Joint signature · receive the scene with Shio	The same truth, all six scenes, original view and souvenir
Exchange calibration	Independent signature · our team receives the scene	The same truth, all six scenes, original view and souvenir
Exchange calibration	Joint signature · receive the scene with Shio	The same truth, all six scenes, original view and souvenir

Independent signature · our team receives the scene

Independent receipt complete. You reconstructed the same river, kept both names, challenged the old-photo and old-scene claims, and watched the thief’s complete exit from the justified viewpoint. Shio leaves the signature space to your team and supports the other edge. Keep the complete ending and original scene card. Utsuro leaves with his screen; the river stays.

Joint signature · receive the scene with Shio

Joint receipt complete. You and Shio record the viewpoint, source and historical caption on one receipt. She signs beside you and lets go last. You see the same complete exit and keep the same original scene. Utsuro loses his trick, but finally takes his bow in an unobscured picture.